



Musk Impersonators

For cryptocurrency scammers, pretending to be Elon Musk has become a lucrative modus operandi
<https://dgit.in/sep18-23-1>



Tiny robots to the rescue

DARPA is working on developing a swarm of microrobots for disaster response purposes.
<https://dgit.in/sep18-23-2>

widely credited as being the inventor of the computer mouse.

The prototype of the mouse was realised by an engineer called Bill English. English based the design of the prototype on sketches by Engelbart. The body of the mouse was made out of wood. Below it were two wheels, with sharp edges. The wheels were mounted perpendicular to each other. Movement in the wheels showed the changes in the x and y axis. The mouse had a single button. The invention was patented under the boring name of “X-Y Position Indicator for a Display System”. A modified version of this mouse, with a “transport sphere” within, instead of the wheels, was later built by Xerox. As the result of tests funded by NASA, the accuracy of the mouse was established and the wire for the mouse was switched to the front instead of the back, to prevent people’s arms from getting entangled.

The Xerox owned Palo Alto Research Center (PARC) facility had on its campus, a version of the computer mouse designed by Douglas Engelbart. In 1979, Steve Jobs was allowed to peek into technologies being developed by Xerox, in exchange for a hundred thousand shares in Apple, ahead of its highly anticipated 1980 IPO. It is said that “Steve Jobs” stole the idea of a GUI and a mouse during this tour. The Xerox made Alto computer had a mouse, which cost about three hundred dollars to build, but was popular among the users. Steve Jobs made another engineer, Dean Hovey, design a mouse that cost less than fifteen dollars to build, and lasted for a few years. The Apple Lisa computer was accompanied by a mouse as a standard input device, which was very well received. Jobs was so excited after seeing the Alto mouse, that he hopped around the room and called it “revolutionary”.

OPTICAL MICE

In the 1980s, there was a rush to develop mice that did away with the trackball or wheels entirely. One of the early input devices actually used audio instead of optics to measure the motion of the mouse. A “visual input display device” patent awarded to Ian Page in 1981, used a pair of piezoelectric audio pickups to measure the movement of the mouse based on tiny acoustic pulses. Steven Kirsch and engineers at the Xerox corporation both came up with optical devices. These early optical mice required a particular kind of pattern on the surface along which the mouse had to be moved. Satish Dhawan also invented an optical mouse, which involved a “mouse tablet” as the surface, with the mouse on top of it. The design allowed users to place engineering drawings between the mouse and the tablet surface. The patent was granted in 1986. 



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